INTRODUCTION

The present international system comprises 192 states who are members of the United Nations, and 6 others such as Kosovo, Palestine, Sahrawi Arab Democratic Republic(Western Sahara), Turkish Cyprus, Taiwan and the Vatican City, who are non-members of the United Nations. Alongside, there has been a parallel increase of other kinds of actors besides the states, who are also challenging the might of the state. It is because of the increase in interdependence among all these actors that the international system has now become more extensive and is not just limited to states and their activities. To comprehend the complexities and functioning of this international system, it is important to identify the major actors and their crucial roles in international politics. Therefore, there has been an increase in interest among the scholars to assess the changing patterns of international system along with its component units.